Direct Speech

Year 4 · Lesson Worksheet

Worked Examples

Easy: Add speech marks and the missing comma: Leo said I am ready to go.

Answer: Leo said, "I am ready to go." (comma before the opening speech mark, capital letter to start the quote, full stop inside the closing speech mark)

Standard: Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause after the quote: Maya said, the bus is late.

Answer: "The bus is late," Maya said. (comma inside the quote before the closing speech mark, since a reporting clause follows)

Advanced: Punctuate correctly, splitting the quote around the reporting clause: Ruby said I think we should she paused wait here

Answer: "I think we should," Ruby said, "wait here." (each part of the split quote keeps its own speech marks; only the first word of the whole sentence needs a capital)

Easy / Standard

(15 questions)

1. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Sofia asked can we go to the park
2. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Omar explained i have finished my homework
3. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Ben shouted i love this song
4. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Leo replied this is my favourite book
5. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Priya muttered the train leaves at six
6. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Theo cried i cannot find my shoes
7. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Ruby muttered the garden looks lovely
8. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Aisha replied please close the door
9. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Jack said watch out for the dog
10. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Zack said i am so tired today
11. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Chloe asked we won the game
12. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Finn whispered we should leave now
13. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Nadia sighed that cake looks delicious

© PassFrame Tuition — for registered student use

14. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Amara shouted i am going home
15. Add speech marks and the missing comma: Maya announced the match starts soon

Standard

(15 questions)

1. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Aisha said, ‘i would love a glass of water’
2. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Chloe said, ‘nobody has seen the cat since monday’
3. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Jack admitted, ‘i think we are lost’
4. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Theo reported, ‘the bus is three minutes away’
5. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Priya said, ‘the stars are so bright tonight’
6. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Ben sighed, ‘this maths problem is tricky’
7. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Ivy announced, ‘the bridge is closed today’
8. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Ruby exclaimed, ‘i saw a fox in the garden’
9. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Freya whispered, ‘please be quiet in the library’
10. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Maya said, ‘we are going to be late’
11. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Sofia called, ‘dinner will be ready in ten minutes’
12. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Isaac insisted, ‘we need to practise harder’
13. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Zack asked, ‘where did you put my keys’
14. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Omar said, ‘hand me that pencil’
15. Rewrite as direct speech, placing the reporting clause AFTER the quote: Noah said, ‘i have never seen snow before’

Standard / Hard

(15 questions)

1. Punctuate correctly, including the question mark inside the speech marks: Chloe asked what time does the film start

© PassFrame Tuition — for registered student use

2. Correct the punctuation: she whispered, "Dont tell anyone"
3. Punctuate correctly, splitting the quote around the reporting clause: Leo said I think we should he paused turn back now
4. Turn this reported speech into direct speech: Noah told his sister that he would help her with her homework
5. Correct the punctuation: "watch out for the step" warned the guide
6. Punctuate correctly: Maya asked are you coming to the party Ben replied I will try my best
7. Why does this sentence need a new paragraph? "I am ready," said Jack. "So am I," said Theo.
8. Explain the rule being used, then punctuate: Sofia said the parcel has arrived at last
9. Punctuate correctly: can you believe it Ivy gasped we actually won
10. Rewrite as direct speech with the reporting clause in the middle: Nadia explained that the museum closes at five and that they should hurry
11. Correct the error: "Look out" cried the sailor, "theres a storm coming."
12. Punctuate, remembering a new line is used for each new speaker: Ruby said are you ready Finn said almost just one more minute
13. Turn this reported speech into direct speech: Aisha said that she was feeling much better today
14. Explain why this is WRONG and correct it: "The dog ran away." said Priya.
15. Punctuate correctly: Isaac shouted duck the ball is coming

© PassFrame Tuition — for registered student use